

Worksheet — Timeline and Sources of History (Class 6 CBSE Social Science)

Total marks: **30** · Questions: **11**

Instructions: Attempt all 11 questions. Show your working where required. Total time: 50 minutes.

Q1. Which year is the EARLIEST? [1 mark]

- (A) 100 BCE
- (B) 500 BCE
- (C) 1000 BCE
- (D) 100 CE

Q2. BCE stands for: [1 mark]

- (A) Before Common Era
- (B) Best Common Era
- (C) British Common Era
- (D) Before Civil Era

Q3. There is no year zero in the BCE/CE system. [1 mark]

- (A) True
- (B) False

Q4. 1 century = ____ years. [1 mark]

Q5. Which is an ARCHAEOLOGICAL source? [1 mark]

- (A) the Vedas
- (B) a coin
- (C) a folk song
- (D) an inscription

Q6. Indian history is broadly divided into: [2 marks]

- (A) Stone, Bronze, Iron
- (B) Vedic, Mughal, British
- (C) Ancient, Medieval, Modern
- (D) Old, Middle, New

Q7. How many years passed between 1500 BCE and 500 CE? Show working. [3 marks]

Q8. Place the following events in the right broad period (Ancient / Medieval / Modern): Harappan civilisation, British rule, Cholas, Mauryas. [3 marks]

Q9. Name the three families of historical sources, with one example of each. [3 marks]

Q10. An archaeologist excavates a site and finds, from top to bottom: (i) iron tools, (ii) bronze tools, (iii) painted pottery, (iv) charcoal. (a) Order the layers from oldest to most recent. (b) Which item could be radiocarbon-dated, and why? (c) What does this tell you about the people who lived here? [6 marks]

Q11. A king's inscription claims he won every battle he fought. As a historian, how would you decide whether to believe it? Discuss the questions you would ask of the source and what other evidence you would seek. [8 marks]

Answer Key

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Q1. Which year is the EARLIEST?

Answer: 1000 BCE

Bigger BCE number is earlier.

MCQ · EASY · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-02

Q2. BCE stands for:

Answer: Before Common Era

Standard meaning.

MCQ · EASY · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-02

Q3. There is no year zero in the BCE/CE system.

Answer: True

1 BCE → 1 CE directly.

TRUE_FALSE · EASY · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-02

Q4. 1 century = ____ years.

Answer: 100

Century = 100 yrs.

FILL_BLANK · EASY · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-03

Q5. Which is an ARCHAEOLOGICAL source?

Answer: a coin

Physical surviving object.

MCQ · EASY · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-05

Q6. Indian history is broadly divided into:

Answer: Ancient, Medieval, Modern

Three broad blocks.

MCQ · MEDIUM · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-04

Q7. How many years passed between 1500 BCE and 500 CE? Show working.

Answer: $1500 + 500 - 1 = 1999$ years (subtract 1 because there is no year zero).

Cross-zero arithmetic.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-02

Q8. Place the following events in the right broad period (Ancient / Medieval / Modern): Harappan civilisation, British rule, Cholas, Mauryas.

Answer: Ancient: Harappan civilisation, Mauryas. Medieval: Cholas. Modern: British rule.

Apply the period boundaries.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-04

Q9. Name the three families of historical sources, with one example of each.

Answer: (i) Archaeological — coin / pottery. (ii) Literary — Vedas / inscription. (iii) Oral — folk song / family genealogy.

Definition + example for each.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-05

Q10. An archaeologist excavates a site and finds, from top to bottom: (i) iron tools, (ii) bronze tools, (iii) painted pottery, (iv) charcoal. (a) Order the layers from oldest to most recent. (b) Which item could be radiocarbon-dated, and why? (c) What does this tell you about the people who lived here?

Answer: (a) Older lies deeper, so oldest → newest: charcoal → painted pottery → bronze tools → iron tools (top). (b) Charcoal can be radiocarbon-dated because it is once-living organic material; C-14 dating only works on once-living samples. (c) The site shows a long sequence of habitation: an early people who used fire, then a culture making painted pottery, then bronze users, finally iron users — the typical Stone → Bronze → Iron progression.

Stratigraphy + C-14 + cultural sequence.

LONG_ANSWER · HARD · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-06

Q11. A king's inscription claims he won every battle he fought. As a historian, how would you decide whether to believe it? Discuss the questions you would ask of the source and what other evidence you would seek.

Answer: I would ask WHO made the inscription — the king or his official, who has reason to praise him. I would ask WHY it was made — to celebrate the king. I would ask WHAT it leaves out — defeats, taxes, hardship of subjects. I would search for INDEPENDENT sources: a rival king's inscription, a foreign traveller's diary, archaeological evidence (destroyed forts, abandoned cities, treaties), coins of rivals minted in the same area. Only if independent sources agree with the claim would I treat it as reliable history rather than royal praise.

Source criticism + cross-checking.

LONG_ANSWER · HARD · 6-CBSE-SOC-TSH-08